

Integrated Hydrological Model of Skjern Å Catchment

Citation and Disclaimer

This README provides practical and background information on the dataset. The dataset can be cited as:

DHI, GEUS (2026). Integrated Hydrological Model of Skjern Å catchment: MIKE SHE model setup, inputs, outputs and observation data. (1.0) [Data set]. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18323823>

See the [license](#) for details on data usage.

[!CAUTION]

This model is **not calibrated** for operational use. It is intended for **educational and research purposes only**, and the results **must not** be used for decision-making. The performance shown here does **not** reflect that of DHI's high-resolution models.

The Skjern Å catchment model and dataset presented here is extracted from **The National Hydrological Model of Denmark (DK-model)** from the Geologic Survey of Denmark (GEUS), and any use of the dataset here should include proper citation to this model. The DK-model can be cited as:

The National Hydrological Model of Denmark (DK-model, abbreviated as DKM; Henriksen et al., 2021; Stisen et al., 2020; Ondracek, M., 2023)

With

Henriksen, H. J., Kragh, S. J., Gotfredsen, J., Ondracek, M., van Til, M., Jakobsen, A., Schneider, R. J. M., Koch, J., Trolldborg, L., Rasmussen, P., Pasten-Zapata, E., and Stisen, S.: Udvikling af landsdækkende modelberegninger af terrænnære hydrologiske forhold i 100m grid ved anvendelse af DK-modellen: Dokumentationsrapport vedr. modelleverancer til Hydrologisk Informations- og Prognosesystem, Udarbejdet som en del af Den Fællesoffen, GEUS, <https://doi.org/10.22008/gpub/38113>, 2021.

Stisen, S., Ondracek, M., Trolldborg, L., Schneider, R. J. M., and Til, M. J. van: National Vandressource Model, Modelopstilling og kalibrering af DK-model 2019, GEUS, Copenhagen, <https://doi.org/10.22008/gpub/32631>, 2020.

Ondracek, M. DK-model HIP - modelsetup 500- and 100m (DK2) V3, GEUS Dataverse, <https://doi.org/10.22008/FK2/27TS3M>, 2023

Intended use

This dataset is designed to support educational, research, and exploratory activities, including:

- Experimenting with integrated hydrological modeling with MIKE SHE.
- Validating model outputs with insitu and remote sensing observational data.
- Testing and comparing model parameter calibration methods.
- Exploring how model outputs change with plenty vs. limited calibration data.
- Building data-driven models, including machine learning surrogates of MIKE simulation results.

Folder structure

The repository is organized in the following way:

- README.md
- model
 - MIKE SHE model (.she)
- * input
 - Input data (.dfs2, .dfs0) for modules:
 - * climate
 - * domain
 - * land use
 - * overland (Only at Zenodo)
 - * rivers, lakes and sewers
 - * topography
 - * saturated zone (Only at Zenodo)
 - * unsaturated zone (Only at Zenodo)
- observations
 - River discharge observations (Q_data)
 - Well water table depth observations (H_data)
- output sample
 - * MIKE SHE output files
 - Waterbalance post processing output
- code
 - tutorial notebooks
- license

- requirements.yml

* This repo does not contain all files needed for running the Skjern MIKE SHE model and notebooks due to large file size, particularly in the folders with * above. The example data and notebooks here are meant to help the user navigate input files, output files, and validation of the model. To run the model and notebooks, the complete folder of setup and input files should be downloaded from Zenodo at <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18323823>.

Introduction

This repository contains an example model setup of a MIKE SHE Integrated Hydrological Model for the Skjern River catchment located on the west coast of Jutland, Denmark. MIKE SHE models the flow of water through the major pathways in the terrestrial water cycle. The model also utilizes the network of rivers, lakes and sewers as defined by a [MIKE Hydro Basin](#) model setup.

The repository includes:

- MIKE SHE model file, input data, observation data
- Model output
- Jupyter notebook guides

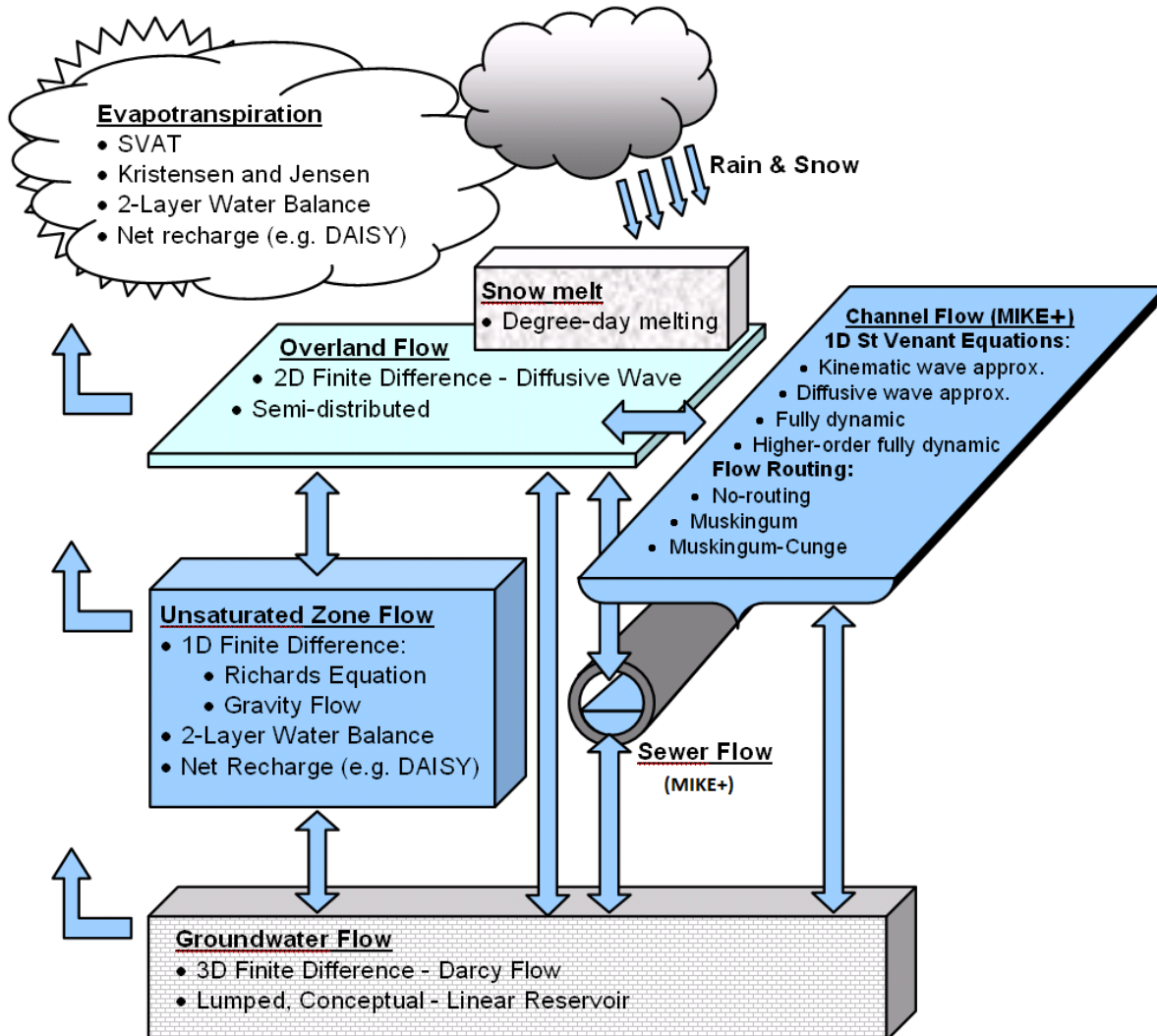
MIKE SHE Integrated Hydrological Model

MIKE SHE is an integrated hydrological modeling system that emerged in the 1980s to represent the physical processes of water flow through the hydrological cycle in a modular way and with relevant scale. The available process modules - evapotranspiration, overland flow, unsaturated zone flow, groundwater flow, channel flow - are each governed by their relevant partial differential equations describing the movement of water through their system. Modules can be represented with more conceptual or lumped alternatives, giving the user the ability to tailor model complexity and compute time for their application. The model also has flexibility in the spatial and temporal discretization, allowing process modules to have the grid size and time step appropriate for the modeling goals and data availability. Typical applications (among many others) for a MIKE SHE model include:

- Water resource management for a river basin
- Flood modeling and prediction
- Wetland restoration and management
- Surface and groundwater interaction analyses
- Land change effects on basin hydrology
- Climate change effects on basin hydrology
- Groundwater withdrawal management

- Agriculture impact
- Irrigation management

A schematic of the MIKE SHE modules is shown below.



Modules for different processes in MIKE SHE with their options for numerical engines. Arrows indicate how different modules interact. This figure is taken from the MIKE SHE user guide and reference manual, found [here](#).

A MIKE simulation can be run using the [MIKE modeling software](#), provided that the appropriate input data and setup files are included. Although input and setup files depend on which modules are included and what numerical engines for these models are chosen, basic inputs include:

- Model domain

- Topography (DEM)
- Precipitation timeseries

Detailed information on what inputs are required when different modules are added can be found in the [MIKE SHE user guide and reference manual](#).

The Skjern MIKE SHE setup



Outline of Skjern catchment on the western coast of Denmark.

The Skjern MIKE SHE model is defined on 500 m grid cells for the period 1/2/1990 to 12/23/2019. Since there is no hot start included, it is recommended that the first several days of the simulation be discarded before analysis. The model setup here was built by the GEUS and includes modules for overland flow (finite difference), unsaturated zone flow (2 layer), evapotranspiration (2 layer), saturated zone flow (finite difference), channel flow (higher-order

fully dynamic Saint-Venant equations), and irrigation. Input files include climate timeseries, vegetation maps, irrigation demand, channel network, river cross section morphology, among others. A more detailed list of input files can be found in `code/explore_input_data.ipynb`.

The model takes approximately 0.4 hours to run in the provided state. Model outputs include simulated overland flow, groundwater flow, evapotranspiration, water table depth, and river discharge. Additional post-processing of the output files using the MIKE [Water Balance Tool](#) can provide a breakdown of water storages by component (fx. irrigation, groundwater, overland water, etc.) for the full simulation timeseries. More detail on MIKE SHE output files and how to view them is shown in `code/view_mikeshe_results.ipynb`.

Model validation

The [ModelSkill Python package](#) developed at DHI can be used to validate model outputs by comparing them to observational data. Example usage of this package can be found in the example model validation notebook, found at `code/model_validation.ipynb`.

In situ data for model validation include river gauges and water table depth wells. Available timeseries for the model simulation period are stored here as dfs0 files, in the folders MapsDK/Qdata/ and MapsDK/Hdata for river discharge and well timeseries, respectively. The location of the measurement stations are shown below:

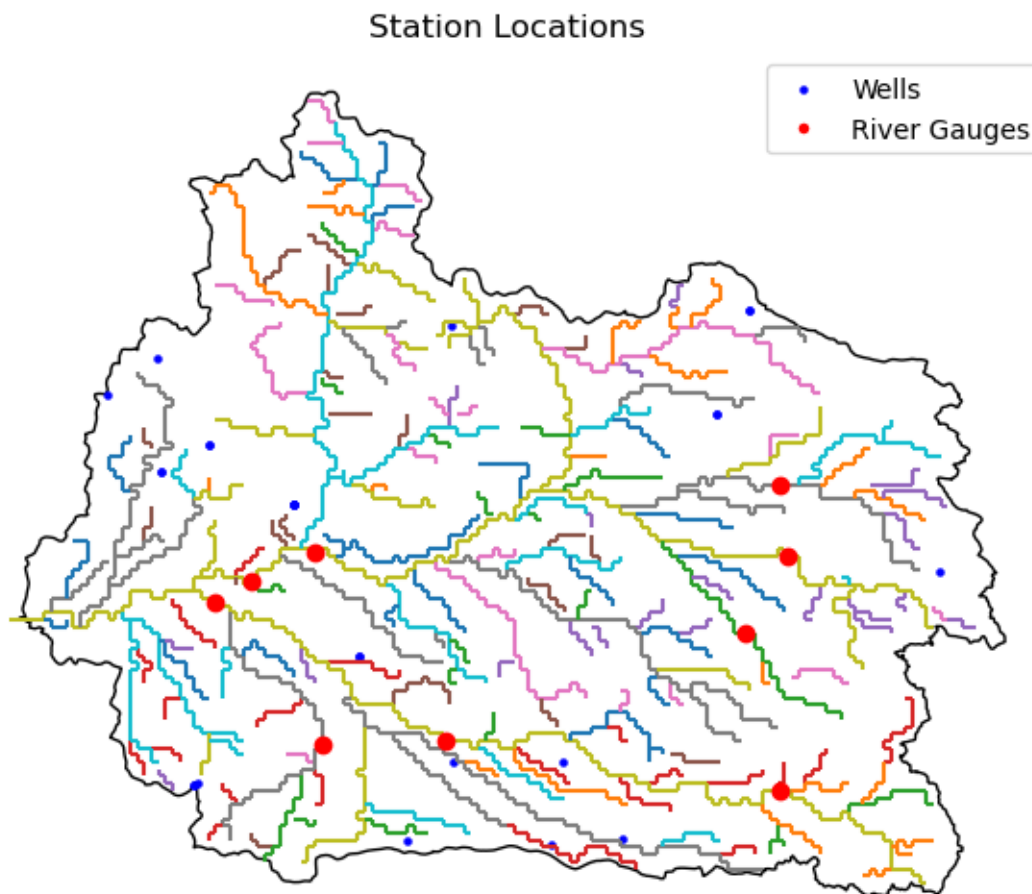


Figure 1: Alt text

An example comparison of modeled and observed timeseries for one of the river gauges in Skjern catchment is shown below, both as a direct timeseries comparison and a scatter plot of modeled vs. observed discharge. More plots like this can be generated for any of the river or well stations in the model validation notebook, found at `code/model_validation.ipynb`.

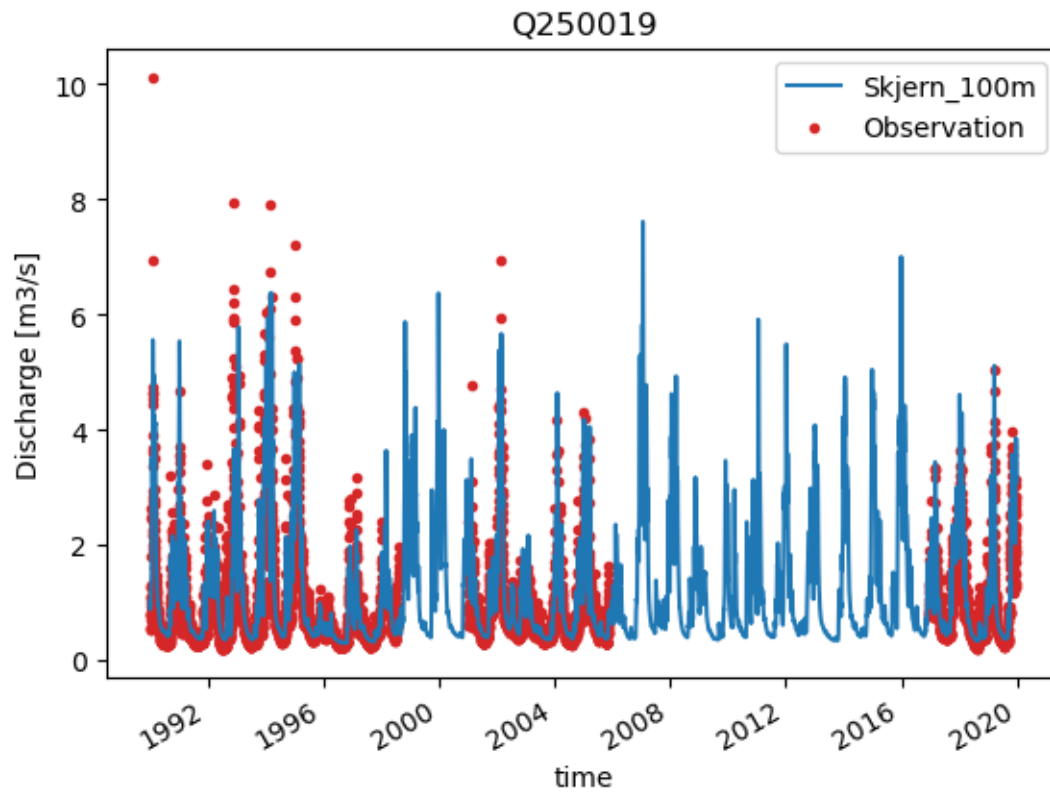


Figure 2: Alt text

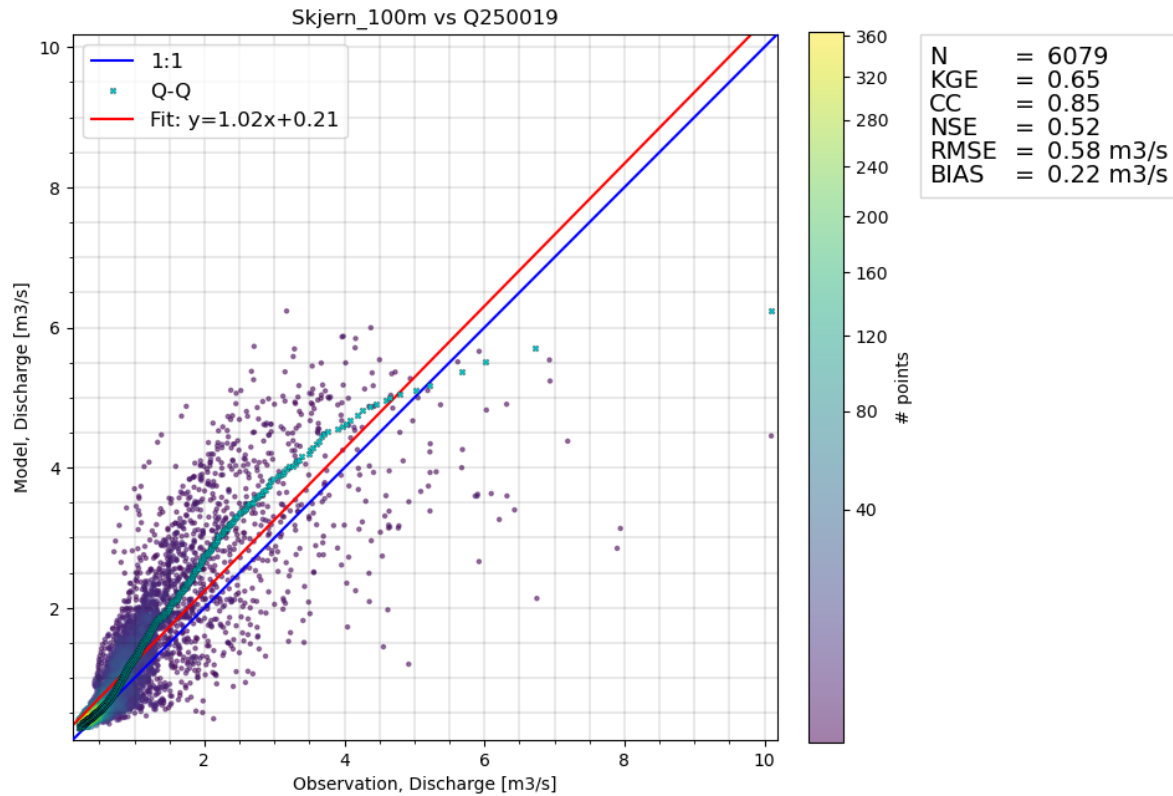


Figure 3: Alt text

Data sources

The data used in this folder come from several sources.

Data Class	Data Name	Source Citation		Li-cense
Climate variables	Precipitation	DMI	Danish Meteorological Institute (2024)	CC BY 4.0, Terms of Use

Data Class	Data Name	Source Citation		Li-cense
Hydro-logical variables	Temperature	DMI	Danish Meteorological Institute (2024)	CC BY 4.0, Terms of Use
	Potential Evapotranspiration	DMI	Danish Meteorological Institute (2024)	CC BY 4.0, Terms of Use
	Observed Streamflow	Aarhus University	Danish Centre for Environment and Energy, Aarhus University (DCE, 2020), at https://odaforalle.au.dk	For use free of charge, see disclaimer
	Groundwater well height and abstraction	GEUS	GEUS National Well Database (Jupiter, 2023) at https://eng.geus.dk/products-services-facilities/data-and-maps/national-well-database-jupiter	Terms of Use
	Model outputs	GEUS	The National Hydrological Model of Denmark (DK-model, abbreviated as DKM; Henriksen et al., 2021; Stisen et al., 2020; Ondracek, M., 2023)	CC BY-SA 4.0
Model Inputs	All other inputs: Crops and land use, overland flow parameters, geologic layers, etc.	GEUS	The National Hydrological Model of Denmark (DK-model, abbreviated as DKM; Henriksen et al., 2021; Stisen et al., 2020; Ondracek, M., 2023)	CC BY-SA 4.0

Dependencies

To run the tutorials and fully explore this waterbench case, the following packages are required:

The user can clone the required packages from the requirements.yaml or requirements.txt

files.

With conda:

```
conda env create -f requirements.yml  
conda activate waterbench_skjern
```

Funding

This work for compiling this dataset was funded via Novo Nordisk Foundation (NNF) Grant Number NNF23OC0081089, as part of the Global Wetland Center.